CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 10

Marlo Quince

MASTER CHANDLER OF CANDLEWICK HALL



"Twenty years at the wax vats. You know how every candle in this house was made."

FOR MARLO QUINCE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A long black cloak or dark bathrobe and a paper crown of candle flames cut from yellow card. Dot gold face paint across your cheeks.

Mask: a plain black eye mask, or two eye holes cut in a cereal box and tied with ribbon.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are the culprit.

You put sleep drops in Vesper's cider. Nobody must find out. You are the only player who may lie outright.

Your cover story: You never left the Dipping Room between 8:15 and nine o'clock. You were dipping tapers for the Costume Parade the whole time.

BACKGROUND

You came to the candle works as a teenager and never left. Two winters ago, with the roof leaking and your pay cut, you quietly sold the Hall's six antique brass candle molds to Hollow Antiques for $1,800 and put painted copies in the display case. Nobody noticed. Then this week an appraiser visited, and this afternoon Vesper took you aside: "Tell everyone the truth at nine, or I will."

WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

At 8:20 you snuffed the hour candle in the Dipping Room and, out of habit, chalked "Out 8:20" on the slate. You went up the Back Stairs to the Coat Room, took the fox mask Jory had just left on hook 3 and a bottle of sleep drops from Briar's sewing bag on hook 5. At the gallery's little cider kettle, where Vesper always leaves the pumpkin cup for a refill, you filled the cup, added the drops and, in your black cloak and the fox mask, carried it to Vesper at about 8:35. Vesper thought you were Jory and said, "Oh, thank you." You hurried back down the Back Stairs, pushed the mask and the empty bottle under the wax shavings in the Stockroom bin, and chalked "Back 8:45."

YOUR GOALS

- Keep suspicion away from yourself until the ballots are in.
- Point people toward Jory (it was Jory's fox mask), Briar (the sleep drops) and Darcy (the heir, also in gold face paint).
- Win the Best Bluffer award.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Use true details wherever you can. You may lie about yourself and your movements, but you may never change what an evidence card says. Stay friendly, stay calm and enjoy it.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You have been giving candle-dipping demonstrations in the Dipping Room since 8:00. At the 8:15 toast Vesper looked tense and said to you, “Nine o’clock, Marlo.” Tell people you took that to mean the announcement. Mention that you saw Jory’s orange fox mask hanging in the Coat Room earlier this evening.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Jory Greaves:** “Where was your fox mask at half past eight?”
- Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** “What did you and Vesper argue about after the toast?”

YOUR TASK

> Get two people to tell you, out loud, exactly where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Tell people that this afternoon Briar complained about not sleeping and said they keep sleep drops in that patchwork sewing bag. Say the Lantern Ghost has been seen every Halloween for years, and that Perry always seems to be nearby when it appears.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Briar Fallow:** “What do you keep in the patchwork sewing bag on hook 5?”
- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** “What were you doing on a stepladder outside the gallery windows?”

YOUR TASK

> Persuade one player that the Lantern Ghost had something to do with Vesper’s cup.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

When the fox mask (Evidence #9) comes out, point out that Darcy wears gold face paint too. If anyone asks about the slate (Evidence #10), say you popped next door to the Stockroom for fresh wax for a few minutes, and that anyone could have chalked on that slate.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Are you sure it was a fox mask you saw, and not some other orange mask?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Who in this house has a key to the Back Stairs door?"

YOUR TASK

> Cast your ballot for someone else, and stay perfectly calm until Script 5 is read.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade